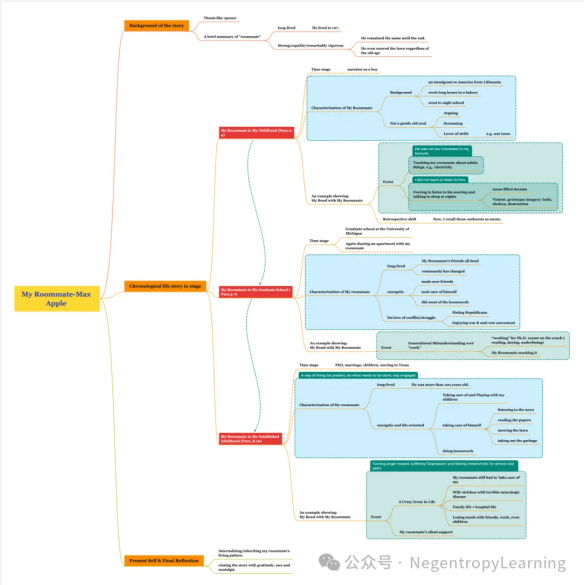


Day 45 我和祖父

绒花儿 NegentropyLearning 2025年11月23日 23:29 中国香港



Part 01





1 I **came rather late to** understanding myself in the cycle of life. (para.1)

📌 Word & Grammar

💡 **come to do:** 渐渐开始..... / 逐渐发展到去..... / 慢慢懂得.....[侧重：心理、认识、态度的变化，经过时间/经历/反思之后形成的新看法或感受。**建议用一般过去时/现在完成时**]

e.g. I came to love this city.

💡 **come to doing:** 事态发展到要做某事这一步；发展到甚至要做某事，常用于描述事态升级到（往往不太想看到的）结果，主语多是 it / the situation / the argument...👉 语气“多半带有不希望发生的意味”，但不是绝对必须负面

e.g. I hope it won't come to fighting.

If it comes to choosing, I'll stand by you.

💡 **come late/early to + 名词/doing:** 很晚/很早才开始接触某个领域，或进入某种理解/状态

e.g. I came rather late to actually accepting every aspect of myself.

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

It took me a long time to begin to understand my place in the grand scheme of life.

在人生的长河里，我对自我的理解来得有点晚。

love

2 Until three years ago, I **was** a boy **in relation to** my grandfather. (para.1)

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **in relation to:** 有关 (about/regarding/concerning) ; 在.....方面 / 就.....而言 (with respect to / in terms of) 与...相比 / 相对于 (compared with/relative to);
e.g. Women are still disadvantaged in relation to men.

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

I had always felt that I was a boy when I was with my grandfather, till three years ago when I suddenly grew up.

在我祖父眼中，直到三年前，我依然只是个孩子。

love

3 He **lived** to 107 and **remained** mentally and physically capable until the end of his life. (para.1)

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **remain** [v.]: 保持/仍然是 (remain + adj/n.) [可以当 系动词 (linking verb) 用]; 留下 / 剩下; remain to be done “尚待完成; 还没有做好”

⚠ human remains 遗骸

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

*He lived to be 107 and **stayed sharp and active** right up until the end.*

他活到了107岁，并且直到生命的最后仍然保持着良好的身心状态。

love

4 A generation after the last of his friends **died**, [时间状语从句]
he **could still mow** the lawn on a hot summer afternoon, [主句1]
and he **insisted** on doing so. [主句2] (para.1)

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **mow** [v.]: 用镰刀/割草机割 (草、庄稼等)

[SYN] Reap



mow = 修草坪 (打理、维护、变整齐)

reap = 收庄稼 / 收成果 (有产出、有回报)

e.g. reap what you sow 自食其果 / 种瓜得瓜, 种豆得豆

⚠️ the Grim Reaper

这是拟人化的“死神”, 通常形象是: 黑袍、镰刀、骷髅、来“收割生命”的。

💡 **insist (on)** [v.]: 坚持要求/坚称; 往往带有“不肯让步、不接受别人的反对意见”的意味。

[SYN]: persist in; stick to; press for; be adamant about; stand firm on; hold one's ground on; refuse to back down from; dig one's heels in about; won't budge on

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

Even a whole generation after his last friend was gone, he could still go out and mow the lawn on a scorching summer afternoon, and he wouldn't let anyone else do it.

在他最后一位朋友去世又过去整整一代人之后, 他在炎热的夏日午后仍然能亲自去修剪草坪, 而且坚持一定要自己来做。

love

5 I usually **wrestled** the mower from his **grip**, but his extraordinary energy I **took for granted**. (para.1)

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **wrestle** [v.]: 摔跤, 扭打; (抽象) 与困难问题“搏斗”、费劲对付

💡 **grip** [n.]: the act of holding something tightly 握力; 紧握; 抓牢

💡 **take sth. for granted**: 把.....视为理所当然 (而不珍惜 / 不重视)

[SYN] take...lightly; be blind to; fail to appreciate

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

Even though I tried with great difficulty to take the mower from his hand, I couldn't take his energy away. And I had always believed that my grandfather was just being energetic.

我通常都得从他手中抢过割草机, 但他那惊人的精力, 我却一直视作理所当然。

love

6 I **had seen** it all my life; he **was** my roommate. (para.1)

Part 02



love

1 At my birth he **was** 64, middle age to him, and he **was** not a gentle old soul. [para.2]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **a gentle soul**: 天性温和、心地善良、脾气温顺的人。

love

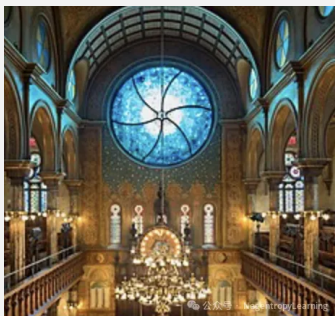
2 He argued with the men in the synagogue, screamed at his fellows in the bakery [主句]

where he worked until his mid-80s. [定语从句] [para.2]

⚠ 文学叙述里，故意不用 and，可以让节奏更短促、更有“动作堆叠感”。

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **synagogue** [n.]: 犹太教的礼拜堂，犹太会堂。



love

3 He was a lover of strife, even at a distance. [para.2]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **strife** [n.]: 冲突；带文艺色彩的“长期纷争/不和”（更书面、文学、宗教、历史）

💡 **at a distance** 在一定距离之外；远远地；[在这里，可理解为就算与他无关、他不在现场，他也对那些冲突很有兴趣 / 也喜欢掺一脚 / 至少喜欢关注]

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

He had a real fondness for conflict, even when he wasn't directly involved.

这个人就是爱冲突、爱看热闹，哪怕隔着远远的距离也乐此不疲。

love

4 For war news he **turned up** the **volume** on the television. [para.2]

Words & Grammar

💡 **volume** [n.] 体积；容量；**音量**；书卷；卷册；量/数量；浓密度（尤其是头发）

⚠️ **crank up** （把音乐等的音量）开大，调高



love

1 We never **had to** take care of each other, [主句1]

but as I **learned** to read, [时间状语从句]

I **voluntarily became** his teacher. [主句2] [para.3]

Words & Grammar

💡 **voluntarily** [adv.]: 自愿地；主动地（without being forced, of one's own free will）

Paraphrase & Translation

We **were never expected to take care of/look after each other**, but when I learned to read, **I willingly took it upon myself to be his teacher**.

我们从来不需要互相照顾，但在我学会读书之后，我便自愿成了他的“小老师”。

love

2 My grandfather **came** to the United States from **Lithuania** before World War I. [para.3]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **Lithuania** /ˌlɪθ.(j)uˈeɪ.ni.ə/ 立陶宛 🇱🇹 It is a country in the Baltic region of Europe. It is one of three Baltic states and lies on the eastern shore of the Baltic Sea, bordered by Latvia to the north, Belarus to the east and south, Poland to the south, and the Russian semi-exclave of Kaliningrad Oblast to the southwest, with a maritime border with Sweden to the west.

立陶宛是一个位于北欧的小国，地处波罗的海东岸，北邻拉脱维亚，东南接白俄罗斯，南接波兰，西南与俄罗斯的加里宁格勒州接壤。



love

3 He **went** to night school, **could read** and **write** English. [para.3]

love

4 Still, I,
the **emissary** of elementary school, [同位语]
considered it my duty to inform him about **subtle** things like electricity [主句]
as he **got ready** for bed after a 12-hour workday. [时间状语从句] [para.3]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **emissary** [n.]: 受派遣的“使者、密使”，可以是官方的，也可以是非官方的，常带“秘密使命”或“临时任务”的意味。



ambassador → 正式大使，最高级别，长期常驻。

envoy → 外交特使/使节，正式但级别通常低于大使，可能是临时派遣。

emissary → 任务性使者（正式或秘密），可外交也可非外交。

messenger → 普通信使，强调“传递信息”。

💡 **subtle** [adj.]: 微妙的，不容易察觉的（not obvious）；巧妙的，高级的，不直白的（clever / indirect）；含蓄的、委婉的（indirect / understated）；思维敏锐的，感知细腻的（mentally sharp / perceptive）（语境不同含义不同，但都带“细微而精巧”的色彩）

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

Nevertheless, *seeing myself as the emissary of my elementary education, I took it upon myself to teach him about invisible mysteries such as electricity as he prepared for bed after twelve hours of work.*

然而，我——那个小学里的小小‘使者’，却认为自己有责任在他结束了十二个小时的工作、正准备上床睡觉时，向他讲述一些微妙的知识，比如电。

Literary Devices

Metaphor

1) Definition:

A metaphor is a figure of speech that compares two different things by saying that one thing is the other. The comparison in a metaphor can be stated explicitly, as in the sentence “Love is a battlefield.” Other times, the writer may make this equation between two things implicitly, as in, “He was wounded by love.”

2) Example 🖐️ Child=the emissary of ES

Calling the child/‘I’ “the emissary of elementary school” is a metaphor. An emissary here could be a formal envoy from a government, church, or military institution. Using such a grand, formal term to describe a young child gives the sentence a humorous, mock-serious tone.



love

1 He **was** not too interested in my lectures. [para.4]

love

2 Within minutes, he **fell into** a deep sleep. [para.4]

love

3 His **characteristicsnoring** pattern **was** a muted **whistle** [主句]
that **ended** in a great **puff** of breath. [定语从句] [para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **characteristic** [adj.]: 典型的；特有的；独有的

💡 **snoring** [adj.]: 正在打鼾的 / 打呼噜的

💡 **whistle** [n.]: 口哨声，哨子

💡 **puff** [n.]: 一阵（气流、烟雾）；泡芙；松软物

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

He snored in a unique rhythm—a soft, whistling sound that always finished with a strong burst of air.

他打鼾的特点是：先发出低沉的哨声，最后猛地呼出一大口气。

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A metaphor is a figure of speech that compares two different things by saying that one thing is the other. The comparison in a metaphor can be stated explicitly, as in the sentence “Love is a battlefield.” Other times, the writer may make this equation between two things implicitly, as in, “He was wounded by love.”

2) Example: snoring=a whistle

Describing snoring as “a whistle” is a metaphor. It likens an involuntary, human sound to a mechanical or musical noise, which softens the image and adds humor.

Sensory imagery (sound imagery) — vivid auditory description

The sentence uses highly specific sound details: “a muted whistle” and “a great puff of breath.” These create a clear auditory picture of his snoring. You can practically “hear” it. This vividness turns a mundane bodily detail into something almost cinematic.



love

4 But even asleep there **was** nothing gentle about this man. [para.4]

love

5 He **specialized in** hating his enemies, even those long dead. [para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **specialize in**[adj.]: 专门研究 / 从事 / 擅长某一领域



major in = 学生的主修专业 (大学/学术)

specialize in = 职业或学术上的专攻领域, 更广

love

6 As he **talked** in his sleep, he **exploded** in anger. [para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **explode** [v.]: 爆炸; 情绪/声音/行动“爆发”; 数量/规模的急剧增长

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

While speaking in his sleep, he would suddenly burst out in rage.

他在梦中说着话, 忽然会爆发出愤怒的情绪

love

7 From his dreams I **learned** the curse words of English and Yiddish. [para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **Yiddish [n.]:** 意第绪语；一种犹太人的语言，起源于中世纪的德语方言，融合了 德语、希伯来语、阿拉姆语、斯拉夫语元素。

love

8 **Cushioned** by his puffs of breath, visions of destruction **crowded** our room.
[para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **cushion [v.]:** 缓冲，减轻冲击；被...缓冲 / 包裹 / 托起（带有柔和感）

💡 **crowd [v.]:** 挤满，聚集；围在...周围； 涌入/挤上；逼近、压迫

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

Rocked by his breathing, our room still filled up with images of destruction.

枕着他的呼吸，各种毁灭的景象却挤满了整个房间。

Literary Devices

Personification

1) Definition:

Personification is a type of figurative language in which non-human things are described as having human attributes.

2) Example: vision of destruction “crowded”

“visions of destruction crowded our room” personifies the visions. They are not just thoughts; they behave like living entities pressing into the room, surrounding the narrator.

Metaphor

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A metaphor is a figure of speech that compares two different things by saying that one thing is the other. The comparison in a metaphor can be stated explicitly, as in the sentence “Love is a battlefield.” Other times, the writer may make this equation between two things implicitly, as in, “He was wounded by love.”

2) Example: “Cushioned by his puffs of breath”

“Cushioned by his puffs of breath” is metaphorical: his breathing becomes a “cushion,” as if his breath physically cradles or protects the narrator.



love

9 Boils sprouted on the intestines of his enemies.[para.4]

Words & Grammar

💡 boil [n.]: 沸腾; 沸点; 疖子, 疖肿

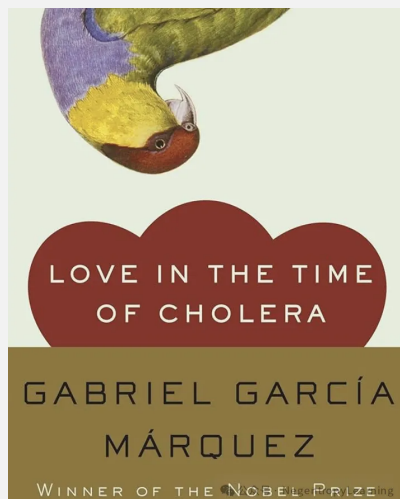
💡 sprout [v.]: 发芽 / 长出 / 冒出

💡 intestine[n.]: 肠子

10 Cholera **depopulated** their villages. [para.4]

Words & Grammar

💡 **cholera** [n.]: 霍乱 [主要症状: 严重腹泻、呕吐, 导致脱水和电解质紊乱。]



💡 **depopulate** [v.]: 使人口减少; 减少.....的人口

Literary Devices

Personification

1) Definition:

Personification is a type of figurative language in which non-human things are described as having human attributes.

2) Example: “cholera” depeopled

The sentence personifies cholera by making it the grammatical subject of the verb “depopulated.” Instead of saying “many people died of cholera,” the disease itself is described as actively emptying the villages. This turns cholera into an agent of destruction, almost like an invading army or a violent ruler.



11. The deep background of his life [主句]
as it **escaped** through his lips [时间状语从句]
became the **chorus** of my nights. [para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **escape through:** 从.....逃出去; 通过.....泄出

[SYN] leak out through / get out through / pass through / slip through

💡 **chorus [n.]:** 合唱团; 合唱

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

The long history of his life, spilling out in his late-night talk, turned into the song that played through my nights.

他那些埋在心底的往事，一点点从嘴里说出来，变成陪我入睡的夜晚背景音。

Literary Devices

Metaphor

1) Definition

2) Example 🙌 his life as music

The sentence uses an extended musical metaphor: the hidden layers of his life are imagined as background music that, once spoken aloud, turn into the “chorus” of the narrator’s nights—the recurring, emotionally charged refrain that shapes their inner world.

Personification

1) Definition:

2) Example: the story “escaped”

“as it escaped through his lips” personifies “the deep background of his life.” His life story “escapes,” as if it has its own will and urgency to come out.



12. I **heard** him [主句]

the way you **hear static** through a radio. [方式状语从句] [para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **static** [n.]: 静电（电荷不平衡产生的电现象）；杂音，噪声（尤其是收音机、电话里的“沙沙声”）

⚠️ 在这句话中

I heard him in the same way that you hear static through a radio.

=

I heard him like you hear static through a radio.

用 “the way (that)... / like...” 把 A 和 B 做显式对比。

📌 Paraphrase & Translation

I heard him like you hear a flicker of static coming through a radio.

我听见他，就像收音机里隐隐约约的杂音一般。

Literary Devices

Simile

1) Definition:

Similes make comparisons between two seemingly unrelated elements by using 'like' or 'as' to highlight a common quality or characteristic both things share. The word "simile" comes from the Latin word "similis" meaning "similar or like." So simile show how two things are alike.



Signals: like, as, as if, as though, the way, similar to...

2) Example: the way of hearing him = the way one hears radio static

The clause "the way you hear static through a radio" functions as a simile. It explicitly compares the narrator's way of hearing him to the way one hears radio static, using "the way" as a comparative marker, much like "like" or "as."



love

13. My young ears **didn't want** to listen to the **uncorked** anger, [主句1]
didn't know [what to **make of** feelings 宾语] [主句 2] that **could stretch**
back 70 years. [定语从句] [para.4]

Words & Grammar

💡 **uncorked** [adj.]: 被拔掉瓶塞的; 释放出来的 / 爆发出来的

[SYN] release/unleash/vent one's emotions;

[ANT] pent-up

💡 **make of**: 对...的理解 / 看法 / 意见

💡 **stretch back**: 追溯到; 延伸至 (过去的某个时间)

[SYN] date back to; go back to; be traced back to; extend back to

Paraphrase & Translation

As a child, I didn't want to hear the raw, uncontrolled anger pouring out of him, nor could I comprehend emotions that had been carried for seventy years.

那时我还年少，不愿倾听那喷薄而出的怒火，也不懂怎样去消化那些能够追溯七十年情绪。

Literary Devices

Synecdoche

1) Definition:

Synecdoche is a figure of speech in which, most often, a part of something is used to refer to its whole.

2) Example: My ears 🖐️ “I”

In “my young ears,” the narrator uses synecdoche, letting a bodily part (ears) stand for the entire young self. This foregrounds the limited emotional and cognitive capacity of the child-narrator when confronted with anger and trauma rooted in seventy years of history.

Metaphor

1) Definition:

2) Example: Uncorked anger

“uncorked anger” uses metaphor, imagining anger as a pressurized liquid in a bottle that is suddenly uncorked, highlighting its explosive, uncontrollable release.

love

14. But now, I **recall** those **staccato** outbursts as music.[para.4]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **recall [v.]:** 记起; 回忆起

[SYN] remember; recollect; call to mind; bring back; evoke

💡 **staccato [n.]:** 断奏（演奏或唱歌时音符彼此断开，短促有力）；断断续续的声音或动作。



💡 **outburst [n.]:** （情绪的）爆发

Literary Devices

Metaphor

1) Definition:

2) Example: **staccato** ➡ **music**

In this sentence, “recall those staccato outbursts as music” uses metaphor: the narrator retrospectively figures the father’s angry, staccato outbursts as “music”, transforming what once felt like painful noise into something patterned and meaningful.



love

1 When I **went to** college, I **switched** to roommates my age. [para.5]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **switch to [v.]**: 转换, 切换, 改变; 转向, 切换到

love

2 Then, in graduate school, I had my own apartment, and my old roommate joined me. [para.5]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **graduate school**: 研究生院 / 研究生教育阶段 (尤其是美国英语里)



college / undergraduate → 本科阶段

graduate school / graduate studies → 研究生阶段

postgraduate (英式英语) → 研究生 (注意: 英式英语更常说 postgraduate course/study)

love

3 All his friends were dead, [主句1]
and he had lived long enough to become, once again, a stranger in the community [主句2]
he had inhabited for more than half a century. [定语从句][para.5]

📌 Words & Grammar

写说明文/作文里说“居民” → residents / inhabitants

口语、故事里说“当地人” → locals / the people who live here

强调“城市/乡村” → city dwellers / urban residents / villagers

强调“公民身份、政治权利” → citizens

1. 关系代词 (who / which / that)

主语位置：不能省略

宾语位置：限定性定语从句中可以省略

2. 关系副词 when / where / why = 介词 + which

when → on/in/at which

where → in/at/on which

why → for which

部分情况下可省略

e.g. the day (when) we met

the reason (why) he died

⚠ 当我们在“介词 + 关系代词”（如 in which, on which, for which）结构中，或者在选择使用哪个关系副词/介词时，**核心依据就是关系词在定语从句中所充当的动词（或形容词）的搭配。**

这个动词如果是不及物动词，那么它后面必须有介词才能连接宾语（即被修饰的先行词）。

e.g.

1) inhabit: vt. 及物 → inhabit + 地点名词

the community (which/that) he had inhabited → 宾语省略，不是 where

2) live in: vi. + 介词 → live in + 地点 the community where he had lived = the community in which he had lived

⚠

第1步：找到定语从句的动词。

第2步：问自己一个问题：“动词 + 先行词”这个搭配成立吗？

如果成立 → 动词是及物的，不需要介词。

如果不成立 → 动词是不及物的，需要介词

love

4 It **was** clear to both of us that **in spite of** a 60-year age gap I **was** his most **congenial companion**. [para.5]

Words & Grammar

💡 **congenial [adj.]**: (人与人) 合得来, 兴趣相投; (环境/工作) 适合自己的性格、喜好 → 舒适的, 令人愉快的=find sb. in tune

⚠️ genial/cordial: 和蔼的 / 亲切的 / 友善的

💡 **companion [n.]**: 同伴, 伙伴

⚠️ company: 强调陪伴的状态/存在感, 而不是具体的人。

💡 **in spite of**: 尽管

in spite of / despite/notwithstanding: 后面接名词性成分

although / even though: 后面接句子

nevertheless: 副词, 连接前后句

regardless of / even with: 语气相近的“让步/不顾”, 但用法和语义略有差别, 不能机械互换



love

1 So he joined me in the late 1960s at the University of Michigan. [para.6]

📌 Words & Grammar



join: 加入一个群体 / 组织 / 活动里, 变成其中一员

participate (in): 参与某个活动 / 过程, 强调“有积极的作用/角色”



love

2 He **made** new friends, **took care of** himself, and **did** most of the housework. [para.6]

love

3 In **Ann Arbor** he **found** plenty of allies in hating **Republicans**, but it **was** even better than that. [para.6]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **Ann Arbor** 安娜堡 [美国密歇根州的一个城市，以密歇根大学 (University of Michigan) 所在地而闻名]。



💡 **ally** [n.]: 盟友，支持者

💡 **Republican** [adj.]: 共和党

共和党整体立场是：强调减税与自由市场、社会文化保守、严控移民与选举制度、支持传统能源，并在“美国优先”的特朗普路线下日益民粹化和强硬化。

love

4 Ideologically, it **was** the best of times. [para.6]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **ideologically** [adv.]: 从意识形态上看；在思想体系 / 政治立场层面上。

love

5 He **could enjoy** both the war and the anti-war movement. [para.6]



love

1 Our only serious problem **was** [主句]
what he **called** my laziness. [名词性从句作表语] [para.7]

love

2 I **was studying for** Ph.D. **preliminary** exams. (Para. 7)

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **preliminary [adj.]:** 初步的, 预备的, 开端的 (用来形容某个动作、阶段、讨论是在“正式行动之前”的准备或过渡。)

love

3 My work **consisted of** lying on the couch with a book in my lap. [para.7]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **consist of:** 由.....组成 / 构成 [只能用于主动语态]

[SYN] consist of = comprise of;

be composed of=be made up of

love

4 Sometimes I **dozed off**, now and then I **highlighted** a significant passage. [para.7]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **doze off**: 打盹儿；打瞌睡；进入浅睡状态 [指在不经意间、常常是坐着或休息时，慢慢睡着]

⚠️ **take a nap** 是主动有意识的去小憩

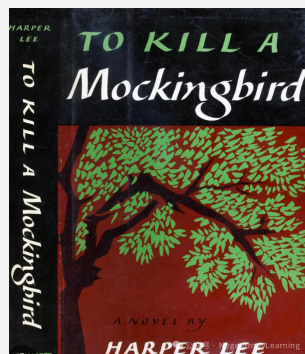
love

5 He **would pick up** a pencil and **mockingly mark** the newspaper to imitate what I **was** doing. [para.7]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **mockingly [adv.]**: 嘲讽地；讥笑地；挖苦地

⚠️ **mockingbird** 知更鸟



💡 **imitate [v.]**: 模仿，仿效（复制某人/某物的言行、样子、声音等）

love

6 I **could not convince** him that it **was** work. [para.7]

Words & Grammar

 **convince** [v.]: 使某人相信; 说服某人接受某种观点/事实 [重点是让对方在思想上被说服, 而不一定是采取行动]



convince → 侧重让对方“相信”一个观点 (思想层面)

persuade → 侧重让对方“去做”某件事 (行动层面)



love

1 But I **did convince** others. [para.8]

love

2 I **finished** my studies, **married**, **fathered** a daughter and a son and **settled** in Texas. [para.8]

love

3 Though (he is) **reluctant** to move once again, my grandfather **joined** us in **Houston**. [para.8]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **reluctant** [adj.]: 不情愿的; 勉强的; 不愿意的; 指某人虽然最终可能去做, 但心里并不乐意, 带有“违心 / 被迫”的感觉。



reluctant = 勉强、不乐意但还是可能去做 (最常用, 中性)

unwilling = 明确拒绝, 不愿意 (态度坚决)

hesitant = 犹豫不决 (不确定, 而不是不想做)



love

4 He **was** exactly 100 years older than my son. [para.8]



love

1 Now that I **was** established, [原因状语从句]

a man with a career, a family, a job, [“I”的同位语]

I **intended to** help my grandfather in the last years of his life. [主句] [para.9]

Words & Grammar

 **established** [adj.]: 已建立的; 确立已久的; 得到公认的; 资深的 (带有稳定性、被认可的意思); 安定下来的; 成家立业的

"Confucius said, 'At fifteen, I set my mind upon learning; at thirty, I took my place in society (I was established); at forty, I became free of doubts; at fifty, I understood Heaven's Mandate; at sixty, my ear was attuned; and at seventy, I could follow my heart's desire without overstepping the bounds of propriety.'"

子曰：「吾十有五而志於學；三十而立；四十而不惑；五十而知天命；六十而耳順；七十而從心所欲，不踰矩。」 <<論語，為政篇>>

 **intend to**: 打算要...; 计划要...



intend to do → 心里有明确打算

plan to do → 更具体，有详细步骤

mean to do → 原本打算 (但可能没做到)

be about to do → 马上要做

propose to do → 正式地打算 / 提出要做

love

2 But in the crazy irony of things, it **turned out** that I **was** the one who **would need** help. [para.9]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **irony** [n.]: 讽刺；反语；具有讽刺意味的情况



irony = 反语/讽刺（可以是幽默的，也可以是温和的）

sarcasm = 挖苦/嘲讽（语气更尖锐，更具攻击性）

love

3 My **solid** life **cracked** in a matter of months, [主句]
when my wife **was stricken with** a terrible **neurologic** disease. [时间状语从句]
[para.9]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **solid** [adj.]: 固体的；坚硬的；牢固的；可靠的；稳定的

💡 **crack** [v.]: 破裂；裂开；崩溃；垮掉（精神/情绪）；破解，破译

[SYN] break down; fall apart

💡 **be stricken with**: 因……而受苦 / 遭受……打击（常用于疾病、情感、灾难）

💡 **neurologic** [adj.]: 神经学的；与神经系统有关的，常用于医学、科学语境。

love

4 The life of the family **became** the life of the hospital. [para.9]

love

5 I **lost touch** with my friends, my work, even my children. [para.9]

love

6 I **could not scream out** my anger [主句]
as my grandfather **did** in his sleep. [方式状语从句] [para.9]

Words & Grammar

💡 **scream out**: 大声喊出来, 尖叫

love

7 Instead, I **turned** it against myself, and it **settled** in my bones as depression. [para.9]

Words & Grammar

💡 **settle [v.]**: 安顿, 定居; 解决 (争端/问题); 决定, 确定; 沉积

💡 **depression [n.]**: 沮丧, 抑郁; 经济大萧条, 不景气

love

8 I **returned to** the couch [主句1]
where I **had studied** for my Ph.D. exams, [定语从句]
but I no longer **saw** anything glorious to underline. [主句2] [para.9]

Words & Grammar

💡 **underline [v.]**: 在.....下面划线; 强调, 凸显 (比喻义 → 强调重点)



1 At 103 and 104, my grandfather **began to** take an active role in helping me care for my children. [para.10]



2 He **did not understand** [主句1]
what **had happened to** my wife [宾语从句]
and had no sympathy for my depression. [主句2] [para.10]



3 But he **saw** the work of daily life in front of him and, as always, he **did** it. [para.10]



4 Although by then he **must have been** wearing **the shadow of death** as an **undershirt**, the aroma of life **stayed** in his **nostrils**. [para.10]

Words & Grammar

 **the shadow of death:** 死亡的阴影; 常用来形容死亡威胁、绝境或极度恐惧的环境

 **undershirt:** 汗衫; 贴身穿的内衣 (上身)

 **aroma:** 芳香, 香气 (尤指食物、饮料或自然散发的宜人气味)

 **nostril:** 鼻孔

Literary Devices

Metaphor

1) Definition:

2) Example: wear 'death' as 'an undershirt'

The phrase “wearing the shadow of death as an undershirt” is a strong metaphor, picturing death as a piece of intimate clothing close to the skin, to suggest how near and inescapable death has become for him.



作者是直接把“死亡阴影”当成一件衣服来写，不是说“像衣服一样”

Personification

1) Definition:

2) Example: the aroma of life

Life is subtly personified as something that has an “aroma” and can linger, making his attachment to life feel tangible.



5 He **listened to** the news, he **read** the paper, he **took out** the garbage, he **played with** my children, he **mowed** the lawn. [para.10]



6 He never **offered** me advice or understanding, he just **kept** doing things. [para.10]



7 After about two years of **melancholy**, I **joined** him, **started** to see how much there was to do. [para.10]

📌 Words & Grammar

💡 **melancholy** [n.]: 忧郁, 忧伤, 惆怅 (一种深沉而持久的悲伤情绪)

⚠️ **melancholic**

Part 03

○

1 Now I **get up** early and I **stay** busy. [para.11]

○

2 There's a lot of garbage to take out and in Texas there's always a lawn to mow. [para.11]

○

3 I **don't talk** in my sleep yet, but even if I **start**, nobody **will hear** me. [para.11]

○

4 Roommates like him only **come along** about one a century.[para.11]

Words & Grammar

 **come along:** 一起来, 陪同; 出现, 到来; 进展, 发展

Paraphrase & Translation

A roommate like my grandfather only appears once in a hundred years.

能遇到像他这样的室友, 简直百年一遇。

修改于2025年11月23日